# University Admissions : Strategic Conversion & Operational Efficiency Report

# Client Background

**Domain:** Academic Recruitment
**Client:** Illinois Institute of Technology
**Focus:** International & Domestic Student Acquisition
**Source:** Excelerate Portal - Internship
**Prepared By:** Krishnendu Das

Illinois Institute of Technology (IIT) is a private research university in Chicago, United States. In 1890 Illinois Institute of Technology was founded to lift up people from all backgrounds with education that would help them meet the needs of the age. Rankings based on the United States Department of Education College Scorecard, which offers the public access to years of federal government data on U.S. colleges and universities, show that more than 130 years later, Illinois Tech is still fulfilling its mission.

Illinois Tech's Campaign was to outreach over 15000+ applicants and make calls over 33000+ to enroll over 100+ global students from (2023 -2024). The available Education Marketing data spans various dimensions and metrics including total & unique applicants, outreach per country, monthly & hourly enrollment trend and university's year over year enrollments.

This specific analysis focuses on the Outreach and Enrollment Funnel, auditing the performance of human callers (Business Process Outsourcing Agents) in converting applicants into enrolled students across various global campaigns.

## Northstar Metrics

- **Outreach & Enrollment Dynamics:** Analyzing temporal patterns in outreach and enrollment velocity to optimize monthly and hourly engagement windows, while evaluating the conversion efficiency of Pre-Admission versus Post-Admission applicant segments.
- **Strategic Market Performance:** Auditing geographic outreach distribution and enrollment-to-performance ratios by country to identify and prioritize high-efficiency markets.
- **Campaign Lifecycle Evaluation:** Assessing lead quality and enrollment yield relative to outreach volume to determine the overall strategic efficacy and ROI of specific recruitment campaigns.
- **Agent Efficacy & Talent Optimization:** Evaluating BPO Agent performance through outreach volume, lead conversion, and call efficiency rates; analyzing the correlation between call activity and outcome distribution to mitigate operational friction. This includes a Year-Over-Year (2023–2024) performance audit and an assessment of escalation rates to identify high-performing Agents(Callers) versus those requiring strategic coaching.

# Executive Summary

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This report outreach over 15000+ unique applicants and make calls over 33000+ to enroll over 100+ global students from [2023 -2024] & identifies a **"Volume Paradox"**: despite a surge to 22,700+ outreach attempts in 2024, returns are diminishing. Through an audit of market, campaign, and agent data, we provide a roadmap to pivot from raw volume to a high-yield, efficiency-first model.

## Strategic Roadmap: Refined & Focused

### 1. Outreach & Enrollment

- **Insight:** Conversions happen early; post-admission efforts are stalled by external delays.
- **Shift:** Prioritize top-of-funnel engagement over chasing admitted leads.
- **Action:** Sync staff to peak hours (10 AM – 7 PM) and adopt a year-round "Diversified Cycle."

### 2. Market Performance

- **Insight:** 70% volume is tied to the "Big Three," while high-yield markets like South Korea & Turkey are underfunded.
- **Shift:** Diversify into developed markets (USA, Spain) to mitigate concentration risk.
- **Action:** Reallocate budget from low-conversion zones (Iran, Pakistan) to high-yield regions (Turkey, South Korea).

### 3. Campaign Evaluation

- **Insight:** 57% of outreach yielded zero enrollments, while the best campaign (AND23) was under-utilized.
- **Shift:** Scale the "AND23" blueprint (10.17% conversion).
- **Action:** Cap resources for underperforming segments (DNA24, FA24DNA) to stop resource drain.

### 4. Agent & Talent Optimization

- **Insight:** Missing documentation (8,000+ "No Remarks") and high escalation rates indicate operational leakage.
- **Shift:** Transition high-volume callers to the "High-Velocity" efficiency model.
- **Action:** Enforce strict CRM logging and deploy "Senior Closers" to clear the 1,100+ lead backlog

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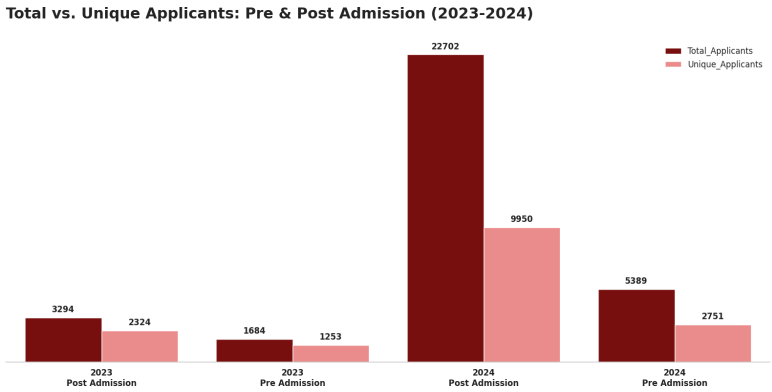
## Strategic Recommendations

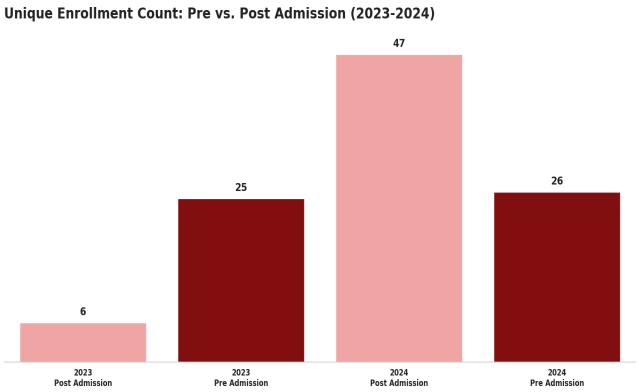
- **Target High-Intent Leads:** Focus on new applicants and task a team to resolve "Conversion Blockers" like visa or tech issues.
- **Tier Markets:** Restrict high-intensity outreach to regions with a >2% Lead Conversion Rate.
- **Enforce CRM Integrity:** Implement a "No Remark, No Credit" policy to close the 8,000-call data gap.
- **Optimize Talent:** Assign top leads to "efficiency anchors" (Jyoti/Palak) and provide targeted coaching for high-escalation staff.
- **Clear the Pipeline:** Use senior support to convert the 1,100+ stalled "Application Required" leads.

# Insights Deep Dive

## Outreach & Enrollment Dynamics

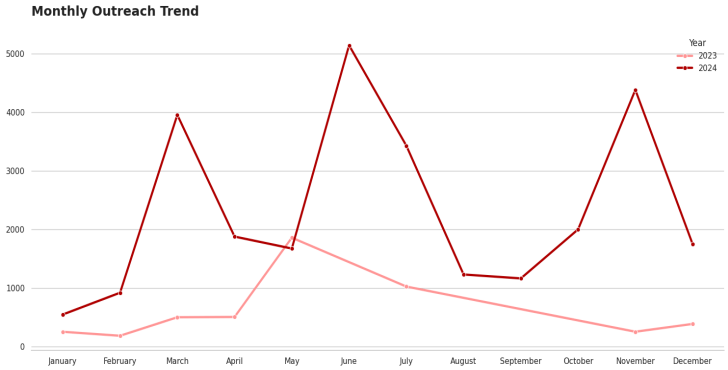
### 1. Pre & Post Admission - 2023 & 2024 :

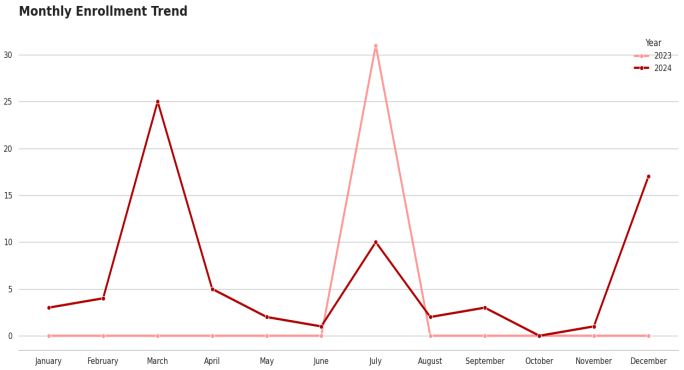



- Pre-Admission Efficiency: Top-of-funnel engagement with new applicants demonstrates superior conversion, yielding significant enrollment volume with lower relative effort.
- Post-Admission Diminishing Returns: Massive outreach volume in post-admission fails to drive proportional enrollment.
- Conversion Barriers: Stagnation in post-admission results is attributed to external factors like visa delays, competitive offers, and unresolved technical queries.

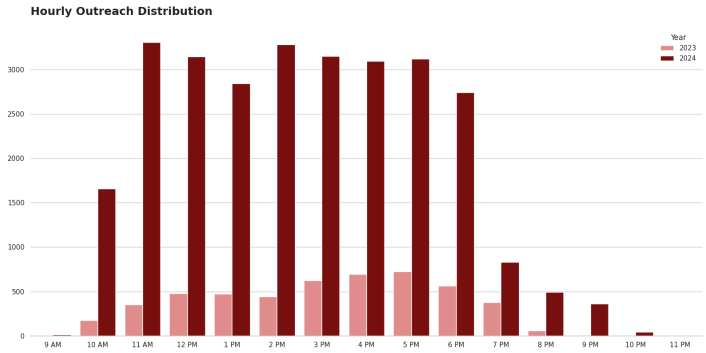
### 2. Monthly Enrollment Trends:

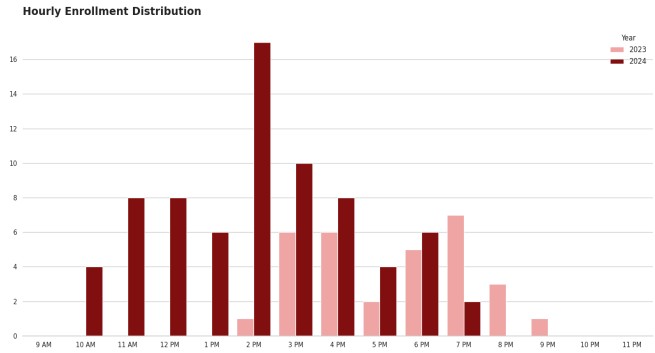



- 2024 Volatility: Outreach surged in Q1 (Mar: ~4k), Q2 (June: ~5.2k), and Q4 (Nov: ~4.4k). However, these massive spikes failed to trigger immediate enrollment jumps.
- Volume Paradox: Despite 22,702 post-admission attempts in 2024, conversions were driven by high-intent "Unique Applicants" and targeted support calls rather than raw volume.
- Cycle Diversification: 2023 relied on a single July peak (~31). In contrast, 2024 shifted toward diversified cycles with notable conversion peaks in Mar and Dec.

## 3.Hourly Outreach & Enrollment Trend:




- 2024: Outreach and enrollment metrics show strong alignment, with a clear performance peak at 2 PM within a broader 10 AM–6 PM active window.
- 2023: Engagement trends were decoupled; while outreach was steady throughout the afternoon, the highest enrollment density occurred during the late-day 3 PM–8 PM period.

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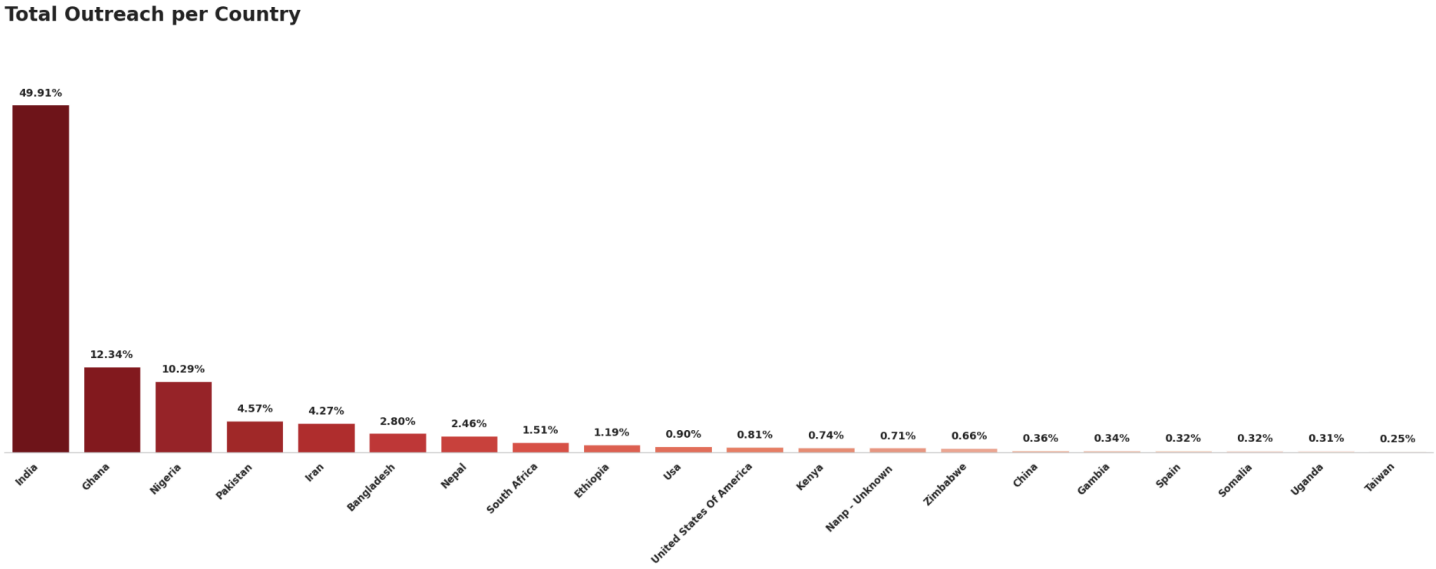
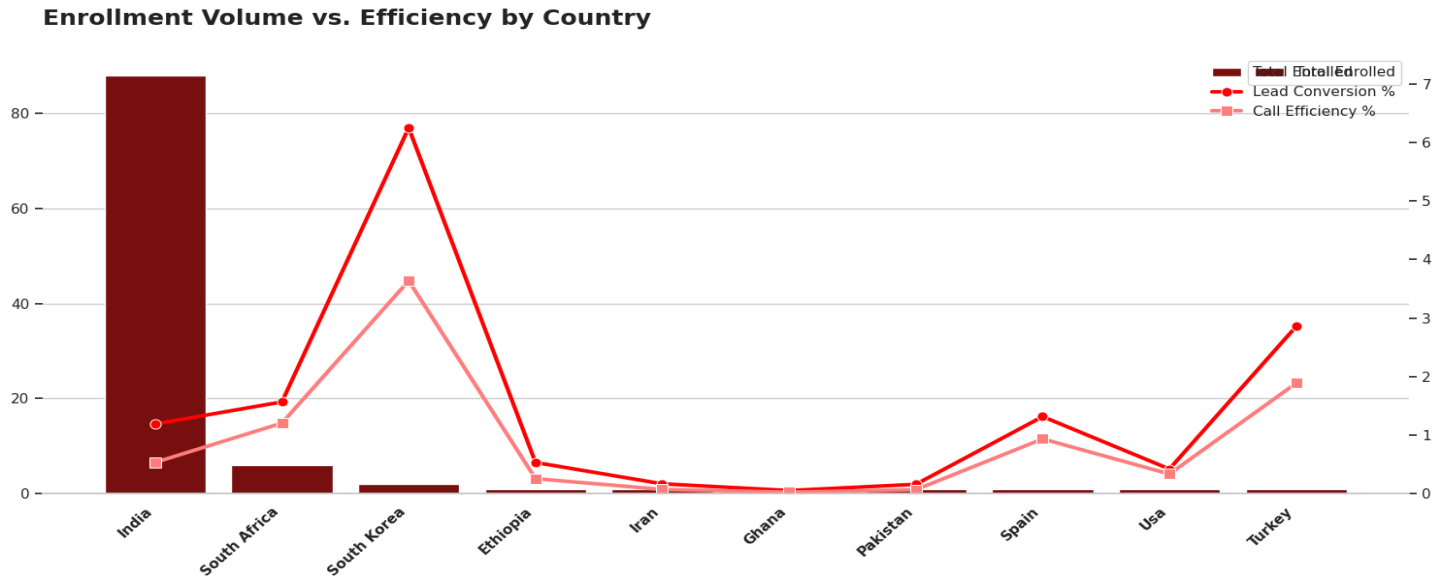
# Strategic Market Performance

## 1. Outreach Volume per Country :




- The campaign exhibits a heavy concentration risk, with Developing Nations driving the vast majority of outreach volume. India (49.91%), Ghana(12.34%), and Nigeria(10.29%) collectively account for over 70% of total engagement, signaling high demand and strong brand resonance within these emerging markets.
- Conversely, penetration in Developed Nations (USA, China, Spain, Taiwan) remains marginal, each contributing less than 1%. This disparity suggests the university's value proposition is currently optimized for students in developing economies seeking upward mobility, while highlighting a significant growth opportunity to diversify recruitment strategies in higher-income, developed regions to balance the portfolio.

## 2. Efficient Markets :




- The data reveals a stark inverse correlation between volume and efficiency. India dominates enrollment volume with 88 students, yet operates at a low Call Efficiency (0.53%) and Lead Conversion (1.19%). Conversely, South Korea emerges as the highest-performing market, achieving a peak Lead Conversion Rate of 6.25% and Call Efficiency of 3.64% despite lower enrollment volume.
- Developing markets like Iran and Pakistan represent significant operational leakage, maintaining high Intensity Ratios (>2.3) but yielding 1-2 conversion.
- Resource reallocation [increase in newer applicants + outreach volume] toward high-efficiency regions like South Korea and Turkey is recommended to optimize Return on Recruitment Effort.

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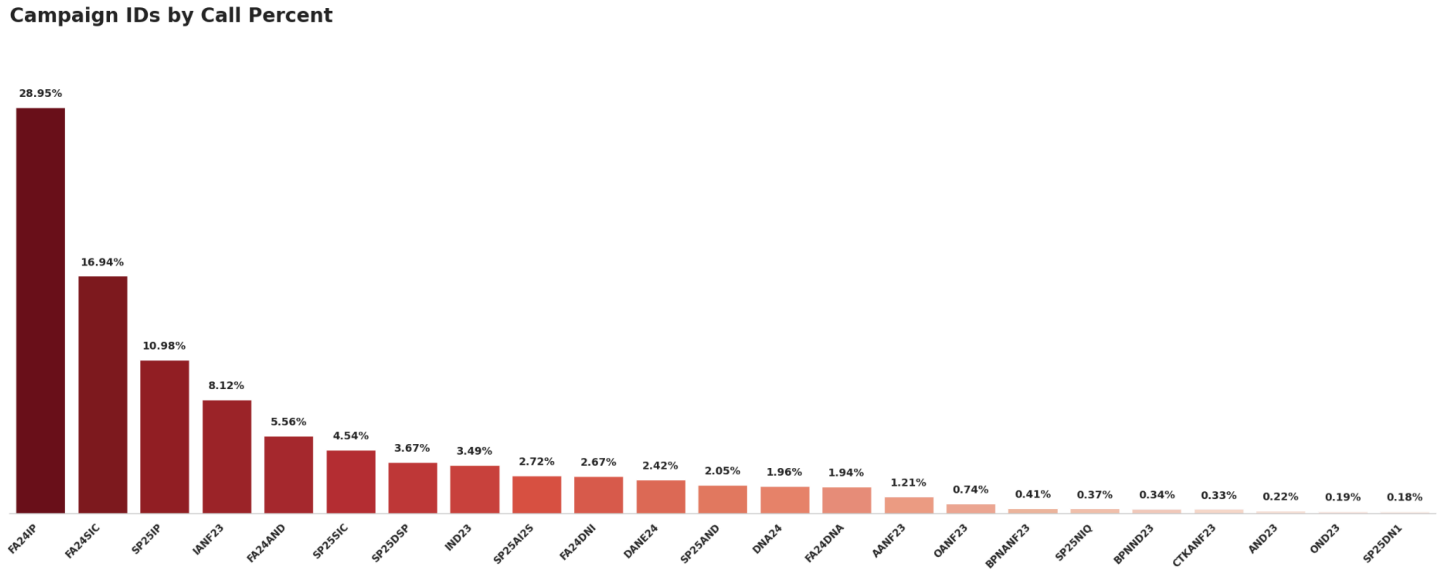
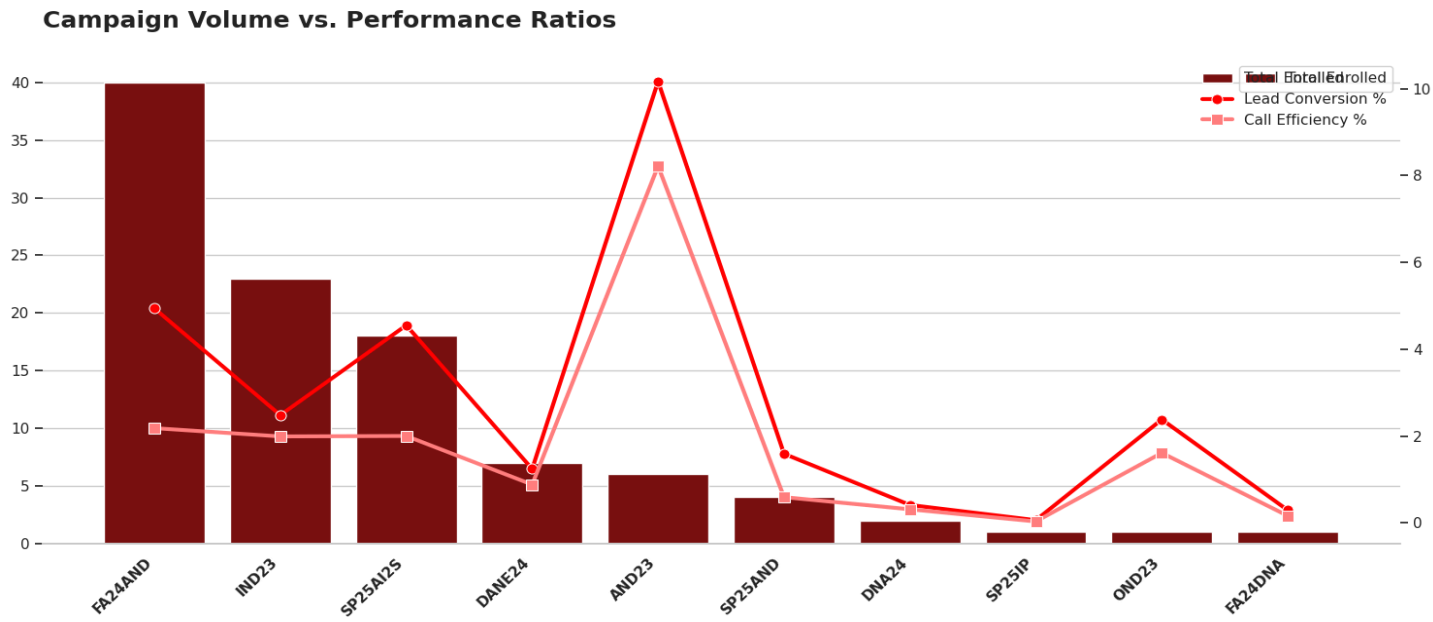
# Campaign Lifecycle Evaluation

## 1. Campaign Outreach Volume :



The outreach is heavily concentrated in three campaigns—FA24IP, FA24SIC, and SP25IP—which together account for nearly 57% of all calls. Conversely, high-efficiency campaigns like AND23 receive less than 1% of total outreach, suggesting a significant misalignment between resource allocation and conversion performance.

## 2. Campaign Return on Effect [ROE]:




The data highlights a clear trade-off between high-volume reach and conversion efficiency across campaigns:

- While FA24IP, FA24SIC, and SP25IP—which together account for nearly 57% of Outreach, final enrollment coming from them stands to 0 %.
- **Efficiency Leader:** AND23 is the top performer in quality, boasting the highest Lead Conversion Rate (10.17%) and Call Efficiency Rate (8.22%). Despite having only 73 total calls, it yielded 6 enrollments, demonstrating a highly optimized targeting strategy.
- **Volume Driver:** FA24AND generated the most scale with 40 enrolled students. However, this required a massive effort of 1,838 calls, resulting in a much lower Call Efficiency of 2.18%.
- **Underperformers:** Campaigns like DNA24 and FA24DNA show significant friction. Despite high call volumes (over 640 each), they produced minimal results, with Lead Conversion Rates plummeting below 0.40%.
- **Consistency:** SP25AI2S and IND23 maintain a healthy middle ground, securing 18–23 enrollments with steady conversion rates between 2.48% and 4.55%.

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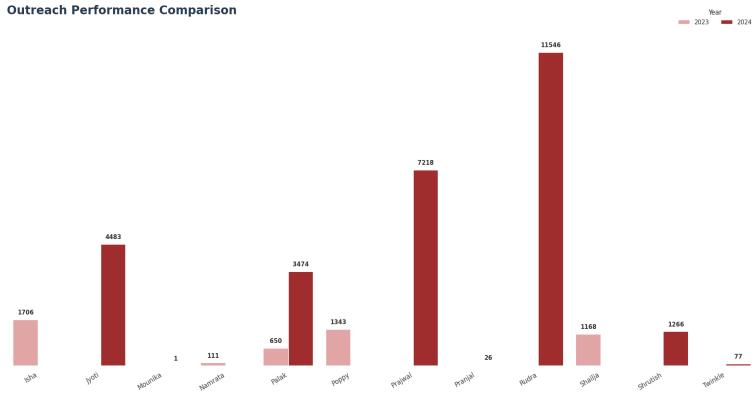
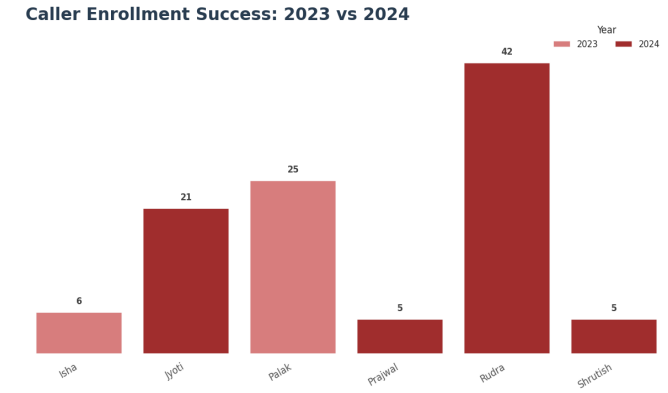
# Agent Efficacy & Talent Optimization

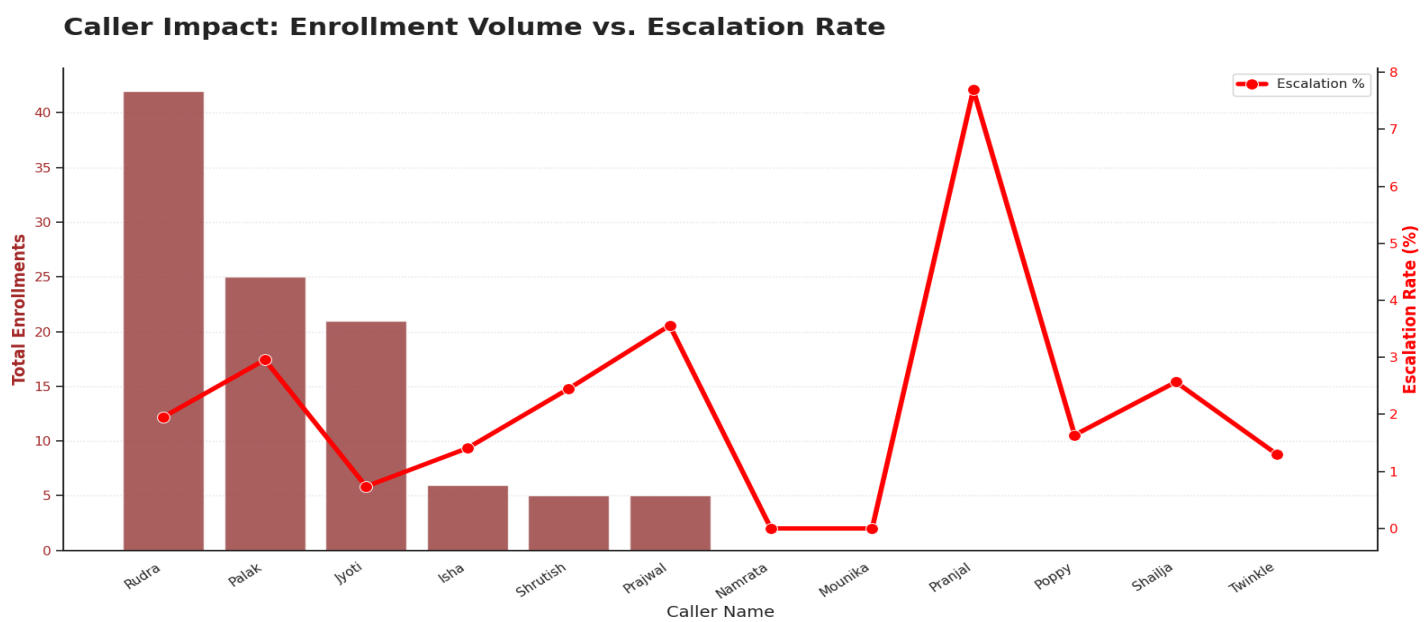
## 1. Callers Performance Analysis: 2023 vs. 2024 Outreach & Enrollment :




- 2023 operations were primarily sustained by Isha, Palak, Poppy, and Shailja, with Palak emerging as the anchor, delivering a peak of 25 enrollments from a relatively low outreach volume.
- Conversely, 2024 performance is driven by massive scaling efforts from Rudra, Prajwal, and Jyoti. Rudra dominates the current period with a high-volume strategy (11,546 calls), yielding a team-leading 42 enrollments. However, Jyoti demonstrated higher conversion efficiency in 2024, securing 21 enrollments with nearly a third of Rudra's call volume. Shrutish and Twinkle appear as 2024 additions with high Operational Leakage, contributing to volume but failing to match the enrollment success of 2023's legacy performers.

## 2. Escalation vs. Enrollment :

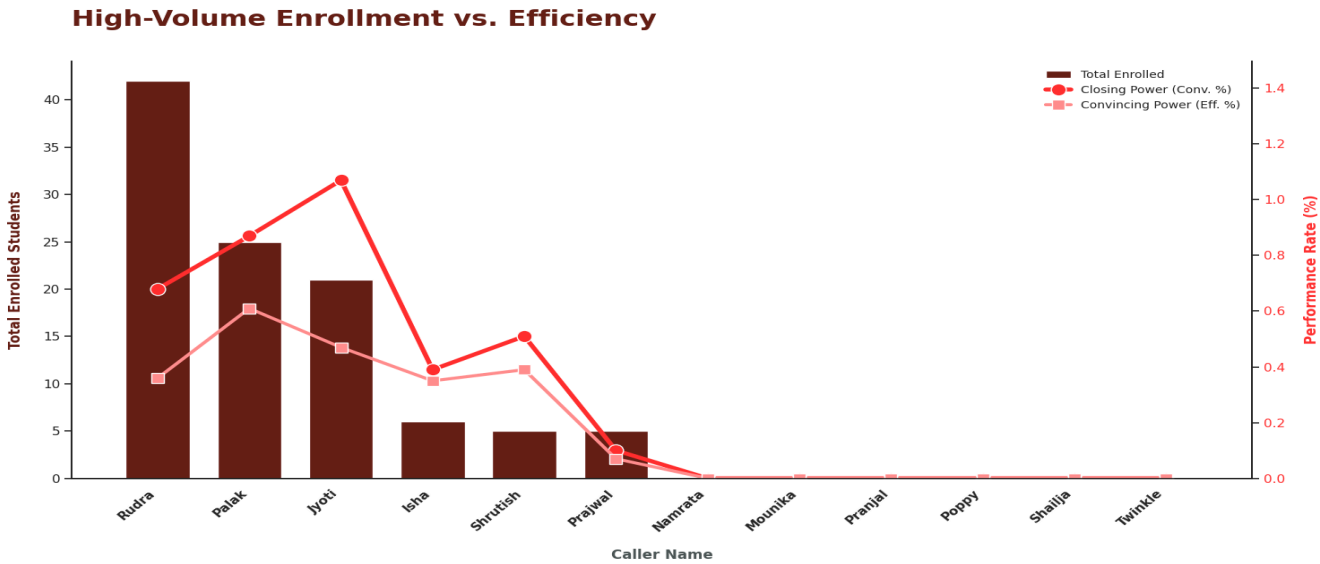



The Escalation Rate serves as a critical proxy for Lead Friction and Closing Difficulty. The data identifies Jyoti as the most efficient performer, maintaining a high enrollment count ( 21 students) with the lowest Escalation Rate (< 1 %), signaling high autonomy and effective communication.

- **High-Volume Friction:** Rudra drives the most enrollments (42) but at a moderate escalation cost (2%), suggesting that scaling volume naturally increases support complexity.
- **Efficiency Red Flag:** Prajwal shows a high Escalation Rate (3.5%) alongside low enrollments (5), indicating that her outreach efforts are frequently stalling and requiring intervention.

- **Outlier Inefficiency:** Pranjal exhibits a peak Escalation Rate of nearly 8% with zero enrollments, representing a significant "Resource Drain" that likely negatively impacts the university's brand reputation.

## 3. Agent Performance :

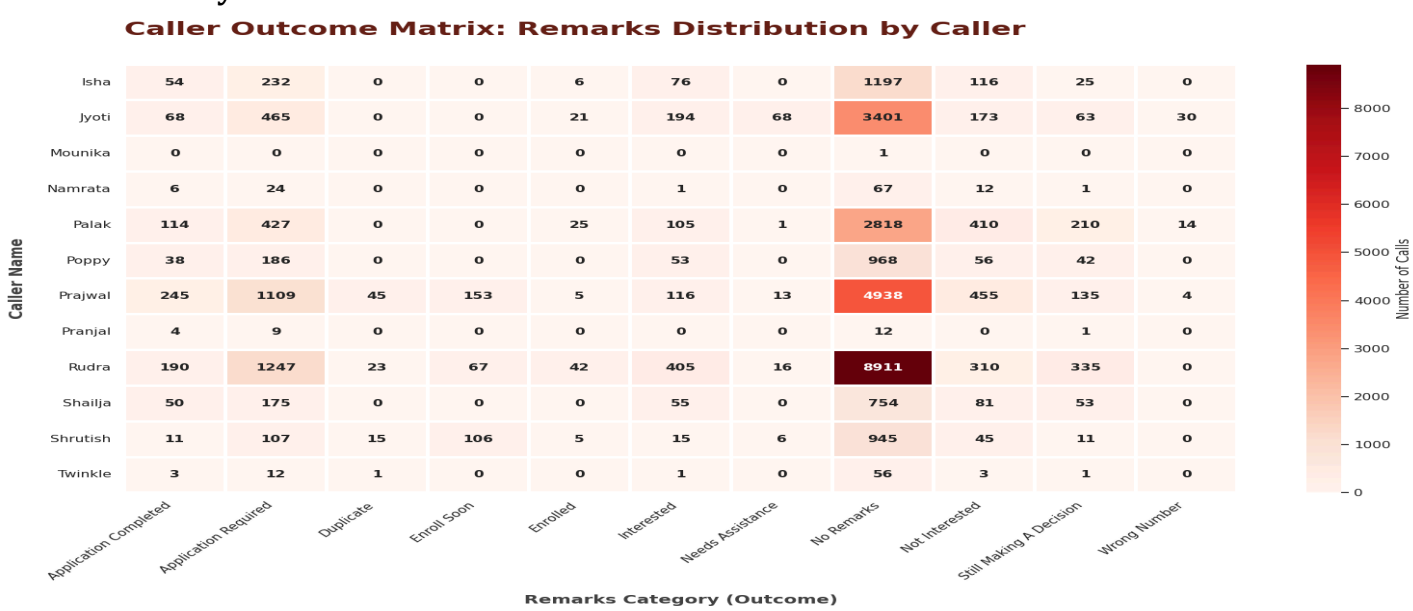



The audit reveals a significant misalignment between outreach volume and conversion efficiency. Rudra dominates total activity with a 34.9% outreach share and 42 enrollments, yet maintains a sub-optimal Closing Power (~0.7%). In contrast, Jyoti exhibits superior Outreach Velocity, achieving a peak Lead Conversion (Closing Power) of ~1.1% despite a significantly lower outreach footprint of 13.6%.

Key Performance Gaps:

- **Operational Leakage:** Prajwal represents high risk, consuming 21.8% of call volume with negligible conversion, indicating a critical need for re-skilling in lead nurturing.
- **Resource Attrition:** Staff members such as Mounika, Pranjal, Namrata, and Twinkle contribute near-zero Return on Recruitment Effort, suggesting their current roles are economically unviable.
- **Training Opportunity:** Poppy and Shailja show baseline activity but lack the "Convincing Power" to secure enrollments; they require intensive coaching to improve their Call-to-Enrollment ROI.

## 4. Caller Activity vs. Outcome Distribution :



The Caller Outcome Matrix provides a critical diagnostic view of sales activity and data integrity, revealing that "No Remarks" is the primary outcome across all top callers.

- **Documentation Gap:** A massive volume of calls - led by Rudra (8,911), Prajwal (4,938), and Jyoti (3,401), lack any qualitative remarks. This represents a significant loss of business intelligence and suggests a need for stricter CRM logging protocols.
- **Conversion Quality:** Rudra and Prajwal show high activity in "Application Required" and "Application Completed," yet their enrollment counts remain disproportionately low compared to their total call volume. Applicants might have changed their decisions at the end or need more follow ups.
- **Lead Stagnation:** Prajwal has the highest count of "Application Required" (1,109), indicating a large pool of leads that are interested but failing to cross the finish line into "Enrolled" status, probably need more future follow ups.
- **Niche Success:** Palak and Jyoti maintain more balanced distributions, with significant numbers in "Interested" and "Application Completed" relative to their smaller outreach footprint, confirming their higher Call Efficiency.

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# Recommendations

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## Outreach & Enrollment Dynamics

- **Prioritize "Top-of-Funnel" Efficiency:** Shift resources toward new applicant engagement where conversion rates are highest; reduce high-volume "Post-Admission" chasing which shows diminishing returns.
- **Resolve Conversion Blockers:** Establish a dedicated "Task Force" to address technical queries and visa delays, as these external factors are stalling post-admission transitions. Choosing agents specifically for pre admission and post admission can also help.
- **Synchronize Outreach Timing:** Mandate a "Prime-Time" outreach window between 10 AM and 7 PM to align staff activity with peak historical enrollment density.
- **Adopt Year-Round Cycling:** Move away from single-month peaks (e.g., July) in favor of the "Diversified Cycle" model seen in 2024 to stabilize enrollment flow by choosing specific outreach sessions (months) for different markets.

## Strategic Market Performance

- **Mitigate Concentration Risk:** Reduce over-reliance on the "Big Three" (India, Ghana, Nigeria) by diversifying marketing spend into high-income, developed regions (USA, Spain).
- **Pivot to "High-Yield" Markets:** Reallocate budget from high-leakage zones (Iran, Pakistan) toward **South Korea and Turkey**, which boast superior Call Efficiency and Lead Conversion.
- **Optimize ROES (Return on Expense Spend):** Implement a tiered outreach strategy where "High-Intensity" calling is reserved for markets with a Lead Conversion Rate >2%.

## Campaign Lifecycle Evaluation

- **Realign Resource Allocation:** Immediate audit of campaigns **FA24IP ,FA24SIC and SP25IP**; these consume 57% of volume but yield 0% enrollment. Redirect this capacity to "High-ROE" models.
- **Scale the "AND23" Blueprint:** Analyze and replicate the targeting parameters of the **AND23 campaign**, which achieved a 10.17% conversion rate with minimal effort. Increase newer applicant outreaches and also increase support calls for this campaign.

- **Cap Low-Performer Spend:** Place "volume caps" on underperforming campaigns like **DNA24 & FA24DNA** to prevent further resource drain and operational friction.

# Agent Efficacy & Talent Optimization

- **Implement "Quality Over Quantity" Training:** Transition high-volume callers (e.g., Rudra) toward the "Efficiency Model" used by Jyoti to increase Closing Power while reducing call fatigue. Reallocating high-intent leads to high-efficiency closers like Jyoti and Palak to maximize ROAS and overall enrollment yield.
- **Mandate CRM Integrity:** Enforce a **"No Remark, No Credit"** policy to eliminate the 8,000+ documentation gap and recover lost business intelligence.
- **Performance-Based Role Alignment:** * **Upskill:** Provide intensive coaching for Poppy and Shailja to improve "Convincing Power."
- **Reassign:** Evaluate the economic viability of low-ROI staff (Pranjal, Mounika) who exhibit high escalation and zero conversion and coach them properly.
- **Intervention for "Stagnant Leads":** Assign a "Senior Closer" to assist Prajwal with the 1,100+ "Application Required" leads currently stalled in the pipeline.